CENTRAL COAST

Bangaloe Stud Kincumber: Plans to develop iconic site into over-50s residential community

Plans are set to be lodged to turn the iconic Bangaloe Stud into a residential community, sparking shock and concern in the Kincumber and Avoca communities.

Fiona Killman, Central Coast Express Advocate

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Plans will be lodged to turn the iconic Bangaloe Stud in Kincumber into an over 50s residential community. Picture: supplied

Iconic Bangaloe Stud in Kincumber has been earmarked for an over-50s residential development, causing shock and concern in the community.

Living Choice Australia Pty Ltd is planning to convert the former thoroughbred breeding stud, on 24ha at 253 Avoca Drive, into a residential land lease community with 210 new homes.

A recent letterbox drop alerted residents to the proposal, stating that a development application is being prepared for Central Coast Council for a "lifestyle development".

The 24 hectare site in the upper ridges of the Picketts Valley

Local residents are banding together, forming the Kincumber and Picketts Valley Community Action Group to oppose the development. The group held a meeting last week which attracted 70

Group spokeswoman Tessa Green, of Kincumber, said while residents were not opposed to development at the rural site, they were opposed to "overdevelopment".

The area is zoned E4 — Environmental Living, which allows for low-impact residential developments including a caravan park.

"People are really annoyed — this is not low impact," Ms Green said. "They have the right to develop but why change acreages into 210 homes. I don't think that's the spirit of the zoning."

The construction access point will be proposed on Picketts Valley Rd.

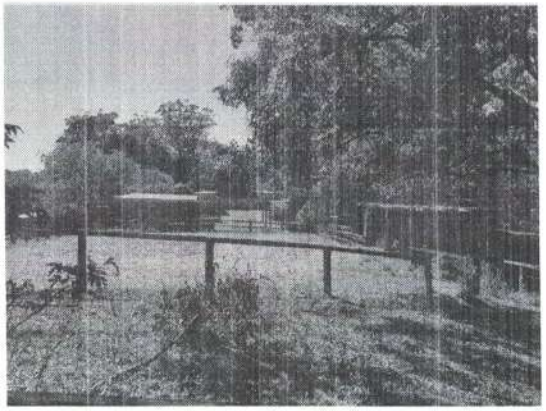
Ms Green said a major concern with the plans was a potential entry site at the dangerous Avoca Dr and Melville St intersection near Brentwood Village. A construction entry point is proposed on Picketts Valley Rd.

"It will affect everybody in the area and people living on Avoca Dr," she said.

"Avoca Drive is already under stress with traffic backed up in the mornings and afternoons. Imagine adding potentially 400 more cars to the mix."

She said the environmental impacts would also be massive, with green corridors linking Kincumber Mountain to the site and dangers to local native species.

The stunning site was sold in 2016 for $12 million.



The old run down stables.

properties.

The letter stated the development "comprises 210 sites and supporting, service and related infrastructure and community and social facilities for the use of residents".

It indicated that 25 per cent of the site would be retained as natural bushland.

"The proposed over-50s lifestyle development dwellings are to be designed to appeal to the premium end of the home market and to complement the surrounds," the letter states.

Danny Bourke owned the stud for around 30 years.

Ms Green said the letter was only delivered to a handful of residents on a Friday afternoon with only a weeks notice for comment. She said those who didn't receive a letter had been shocked by the news.

There are many surrounding properties which border the fence line of the land.

The unique parcel of land was a successful thoroughbred breeding enterprise for more than 50 years.

Former owner Danny Bourke, who owned the property for around 30 years, sold the site in 2016 for $12 million to move onto "new beginnings".

Living Choice had the sprawling Kincumber acreage in its sight for quite some time, indicating at the time of sale it would turn the site into a unique coast-meets-country retirement village.

However, a DA for a retirement village was rejected by Central Coast Council.

The DA for the over 50s residential community is expected to be lodged in December.

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